



NEGOTIATION GENIUS

How to Overcome Obstacles
and Achieve Brilliant Results at
the Bargaining Table and Beyond

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The Big “So What”

Negotiation skills are essential for success in all areas of life, from business to politics and personal life. This book equips you with proven principles, strategies and tactics to become an effective negotiator.



Introduction



A negotiation genius is someone who can (i) consistently negotiate successful deals while (ii) preserving his integrity/reputation and (iii) strengthening the relationship. Successful negotiations don't come from inborn talent or intuition. They come from careful preparation, sound strategies and tactics. In this book, the authors present the negotiation framework and tools that they've researched, tested and refined in executive programs and real-world corporations.



In this summary, we'll present the insights in 2 parts: (i) The Negotiation Toolkit, and (ii) Negotiating in the Real-World.



Part 1: The Negotiation Toolkit



Claiming and Creating Value in Negotiation



The goal of negotiation isn't to achieve win-win outcomes. It's to create value such that both sides are better off with an agreement than without.

KEY QUOTES

"What appears to be genius actually reflects careful preparation, an understanding of... negotiation...and the ability to structure and execute negotiations strategically and systematically."

"A good negotiator plays the game well; a negotiation genius changes the nature of the game itself."

KEY QUOTES

- During the 1912 U.S. presidential elections, a campaign manager printed 3 million copies of Theodore Roosevelt's photo before he realized that he didn't have permission to use it. The copyrights alone could've cost \$3mil (equivalent to \$60mil today). Instead of paying a hefty fee, the campaign manager asked the photographer how much he'd pay for this once-in-a-lifetime opportunity to feature his photo, and received \$250 from the photographer!



Claiming vs creating value. Value is subjective and can mean different things to different people.

- In some cases, a negotiation involves only 1 divisive issue (e.g. the price for buying/selling a house). In such cases, 1 party's gain is at the other party's expense, and your goal is to claim the most value without hurting the relationship or your reputation.
- However, in most cases, it's possible to create value to improve the deal for both sides. After all, 50% of a \$200 pie is better than 80% of a \$100 pie.
 - (i) One of the best ways to create value is to *add issues* to a negotiation. This creates more currencies for exchange, making it possible for each side to get something it values more, by giving away something it values less. For example, in a business deal, you can go beyond price to discuss financing, warranties, post-sales support etc.
 - (ii) *Logrolling* = trading across issues. As a rule of thumb, if the other party values something more than you do, give it to them in exchange for something of greater priority to you. Let's imagine you're negotiating the licensing fees for a sitcom. A higher licensing fee will benefit the sitcom at the expense of the TV station. However, if you concede to more runs per episode in exchange for a higher licensing fee, it'll benefit both sides since the revenue from the extra runs can more than cover the additional licensing fee.

"Value is whatever people find useful or desirable... Negotiation helps to create value through agreements that make both parties better off than they were without an agreement."

"Getting a good deal in negotiation is not simply about claiming as much value as you can. Often, a much more important (and difficult) task is to create value and increase the size of the pie."

"A good negotiator will do whatever it takes to close the deal, while a negotiation genius will do whatever it takes to maximize value in the deal."



Pre-Negotiation: Preparation is Key



Great negotiation requires prior preparation: you need to gather information about the situation and the other party, decide what you want, craft your negotiation strategy, etc. To claim the most value from your negotiations:

- Determine your BATNA (Best Alternative to Negotiated Agreement), or what you'll do without an agreement. Identify all possible options if negotiations were to fail, estimate the value of each option and select your best fallback option (i.e. your BATNA). This isn't what you think is "fair" nor what you hope for. It's what you're prepared to face if you don't have an agreement.
- Calculate your Reservation Value (RV), or the point you'll walk away from the negotiations. If you're selling your car, then this is the absolute lowest price you're willing to sell your car for.
- Assess the other party's BATNA, i.e. what they could do if there's no agreement.
- Estimate the other party's RV.
- Calculate the ZOPA (or the zone of possible agreement). This is the range between the 2 RVs, or the set of possible deals that may be acceptable to both sides.



To prepare for value-creation, go beyond the BATNA, RV and ZOPA:

- Identify your range of interests which can be fulfilled by the other party.
- Create a scoring system to reflect each item's relative priority.
- Calculate your Package Reservation Value (PRV).
- Identify the other party's range of interests.

KEY QUOTES

"Your BATNA is the reality you will face if you reach no deal in the current negotiation."



During Negotiation: Get the Best Possible Deal



If you have enough info to be confident of the other party's RV, make the first offer to create an "anchor" or reference point for the negotiation.

- Assuming you have enough info to make the first offer:
 - (i) Make an offer *outside the ZOPA*. This forces the other side to negotiate their way into the ZOPA and keeps the entire ZOPA in play. For example, if you're selling a plot of land with a ZOPA of \$41-55 mil, make an initial offer above \$55 mil.
 - (ii) Go for the most aggressive offer that you can justify. Explain the *reasons* for the offer so your counterpart won't feel offended or think it's impossible to reach an agreement.
 - (iii) Remember: you want to get the best possible deal while improving your reputation and relationship. So, set *high but realistic goals* given the context and relationship.
- If the other party makes the first offer, you must consciously counter the effects of anchoring:
 - (i) *Ignore the anchor* by switching to a different topic, e.g. "From your offer, it seems we have different views on this deal. Perhaps we can bridge the gap by exploring [new topic]."
 - (ii) Make an *aggressive counter-offer* to capture the full range of ZOPA, then suggest that you bridge the gap together.
 - (iii) If their offer is way outside the ZOPA, explain your position and invite them to *reopen the negotiations* from a new starting point.
- Our satisfaction with a deal depends less on the actual outcome than our *perception* of the outcome. Your counterpart will be satisfied so long as they think they got a good deal and were treated fairly and respectfully. So, if they make an unbelievably good offer, don't accept it immediately or they'll feel stupid. Instead, it's better to:

KEY QUOTES

"Asking for too little diminishes the amount of value you can capture; asking for too much diminishes your chances of consummating the deal."

"Aspirations influence first offers, which in turn influence final prices."

"Satisfaction has everything to do with how well you think you did, and often little or nothing to do with how well you actually did."

- (i) Wait, make a counteroffer or ask for more concessions. This actually makes them happier than if you agree right away.
- (ii) Give something back generously.
- (iii) Ask yourself what they may know that you don't, i.e. is there a catch that you may have missed?



Use these haggling strategies to bargain more effectively:

- To capture more value, focus on their BATNA/RV instead of yours.
- Make use of silences. Resist the urge to speak after you've made your offer. Or, stay silent after they make an extreme offer so they may volunteer a concession.
- Don't make unilateral concessions—always go for reciprocity. Label your concessions to make them explicit, and specify what you expect in return for your concession. Or, make your concessions contingent on certain conditions.
- Be aware of the diminishing rate of concessions. As the other side approaches their RV, the concession tends to get smaller. This can also be used to create the illusion that you're close to your RV.



Use these strategies to create and maximize value for both sides:

- Negotiate multiple issues at the same time to allow for logrolling.
- Reach agreement only after discussing all the issues, so you can consider trade-offs using package offers.
- Apply Pareto improvement, i.e. change parts of a deal that'd make at least 1 party better off without making anyone else worse off. Keep doing so until you reach Pareto efficiency, when it's impossible for 1 party to gain more without hurting the others.
- When both sides have drastically different expectations and can't agree on who's right or wrong, contingency contracts can be used to break the impasse. For example,

KEY QUOTES

"You are negotiating not just the deal, but also the relationship."

"Effective negotiators understand not only the power of silence, but also the need to be comfortable with it...remind yourself that if you speak when it is their turn, you will be paying by the word."

"The relative importance of each issue to each party only becomes apparent when the issues are discussed simultaneously."

if you can't agree on the expected ratings for a sitcom (which affect the licensing fees), try using a clause like this: If the ratings are above the benchmark number, they'll get \$X rebate; if it's below the benchmark, they'll pay a surcharge.



You can't maximize value if both sides refuse to share information. Use these strategies to gather useful information:

- Gather all potential sources of info before the negotiations, e.g. public info, historical data, information from personal/business contacts.
- Know what you don't know. Intentionally ask questions to verify your assumptions and revise your estimates. For example, if you're unsure if the buyer intends to use the land for commercial or residential development, you can say, "This plot of land will be very valuable if it's used for commercial development. What are your plans for this real estate?"
- Great negotiation isn't about selling your proposal or persuading them of your strengths. It's about the ability to listen and understand where they're coming from, so you can structure a deal that maximizes value for both sides.
- Don't dismiss their demands or constraints. See them as opportunities to create/capture value.
- Don't just focus on what they want; ask why they want it or why they're saying "no". A large corporation wanted exclusivity from a small supplier, but the latter had to refuse because the owner had an existing supply agreement with his cousin. Once the "why" was known, both sides could agree on an exclusivity clause while still allowing the owner to supply to his cousin.
- You can't expect your counterpart to tell you their RV, but you can ask indirect questions to improve your estimates. For example, you can ask how this deal fits with their overall strategy, ask about their customer profiles/needs or future projects.

KEY QUOTES

"Negotiation is an information game. Those who know how to obtain information perform better than those who stick with what they know."

"Negotiation geniuses know how to act on information they have, acquire information they do not."

"Every offer is a combination of information and influence. The other party's offer tells you something about what she believes and what she wants (information), but it also has the power to derail your strategy (influence)."

KEY QUOTES

"Negotiation geniuses do not simply leverage trust when it is present; they build trust when it is absent."

- Learn to separate information from influence. Pause to consider if the info is really something new, or if you're influenced by the way it's being presented. We'll elaborate on this in Part 2.
- If the other party is reticent, you need to first build trust: (i) use their lingo, (ii) invest the effort to build personal/informal ties outside the negotiations, (iii) nurture the relationship in advance (not only when you want something), and (iv) give away some info first (e.g. share your relative priorities without revealing the absolute value of each priority).
- If the other party still isn't forthcoming, try making 2 different offers simultaneously. These offers may be of equal value to you, but contain variations to help you gauge their relative priorities. If neither offer is acceptable, you can then ask "which offer is closer to something you can accept?"
- Use contingency contracts to protect yourself from areas of uncertainty. For example, if you're unsure whether the buyer will honor their promise to use the land for non-commercial use, you can add a clause to say that they must pay an extra \$X if the land is used for commercial development within 10 yrs.



Post-Negotiation: Maximize Satisfaction and Value



We may feel unhappy about a negotiation if we think that we could've secured an even better deal. To maximize your satisfaction: focus on your ambitious targets during the negotiation, but switch to focusing on your RV once the negotiation is over.



After signing the initial agreement, you can continue to create value with a post-settlement settlement (PSS). Acknowledge the progress made with the initial agreement. Then, tell your counterpart that you've already given all possible concessions, but are still willing to think out of the box to help them.

- The goal isn't to reverse the agreement or squeeze new concessions. It's to give both sides the opportunity to

mutually improve the agreement, or at least achieve Pareto improvement.

- If neither party can think of better ideas, your initial agreement will now become your BATNA.



Part 2: Negotiating in the Real World



Psychology in Negotiations



All human beings—including experienced negotiators—are subject to mental and emotional biases/errors. These create conflict and distrust, hinder our ability to learn from experiences, and lead to sub-optimal outcomes. Negotiation geniuses learn to minimize their own mistakes while leveraging others' mistakes.

- Our brains take shortcuts so we can make decisions quickly. However, such cognitive biases can result in irrational decisions.
 - (i) The *fixed-pie bias* is the assumption that you're in a zero-sum game, and one party's gain is the other party's loss. It's hard to collaborate when each side sees the other as an enemy, focuses on grabbing a larger chunk of the pie, and dismisses the proposals/concessions made by the other side.
 - (ii) The *vividness bias* is our tendency to focus too much on vivid features/data, to neglect dull but important info.
 - (iii) Once we're in a competitive/combatative mode, we may end up in an *irrational escalation of commitment*. We try to win at all costs even if it sabotages our own goal.
 - (iv) We're also *susceptible to framing*, i.e. we'll respond differently to the same info when it's presented differently. For instance, we tend to be risk-averse when thinking about potential gains (i.e. we want guaranteed wins), but risk-seeking when thinking about potential losses (i.e. we switch to an "all or

KEY QUOTES

"In the context of decision-making and negotiation, many of the mistakes people make are systematic and predictable."

"It is better to assume that you can enlarge the pie and later find out that you were wrong than to assume the pie is fixed and never find out you were wrong."

"Once you are a "loser," you won't mind digging yourself into a bigger hole (i.e., losing even more) as long as there is some possibility of digging yourself out entirely."

nothing" mentality if we have something to lose). You may hesitate to bet your first \$100 at the casino. Yet, after losing \$800, you'll be more willing to bet another \$100 to try and win back your losses.

- We also act irrationally due to motivational or emotional biases.
 - (i) Often, we're torn between what know we *should* do vs what we *want* to do. In a real story, a dispute over window grills (worth \$909) ended up costing the parties \$100,000 in legal fees over 6 years. They spent an illogical amount of time/money just to satisfy their desire for justice.
 - (ii) We also tend to view ourselves with a *positive bias*. We play up things that make us look good, and play down things that make us look bad. We're also prone to overconfidence, irrational optimism, and the illusion of superiority. We think that we're better (smarter, fairer, more flexible, etc.) than others, and believe our views to be more valid.
 - (iii) We adopt *self-serving attributions*—we attribute our successes to internal reasons (e.g. skills, personality, creativity) and our failures to external reasons (e.g. bad luck). We do the opposite for others—we attribute their successes to external reasons and their failures to internal reasons.
 - (iv) We tend to hold out more/longer than we should due to *regret aversion*, or the desire to avoid any cause for regret.



Negotiation geniuses seek to manage such biases:

- Our brains have 2 default systems. System 1 is fast, automatic, and emotional. System 2 is slower, deliberate and logical. Facilitate System 2 thinking with the following:
 - (i) Set aside time for *pre-planning*. Create a scoring system to remember your real interests, and develop an exit strategy (e.g. set a cut-off point where you'll stop bidding).
 - (ii) Don't negotiate under *time pressure*.

KEY QUOTES

"We view the world the way we wish it were rather than how it truly is."

"Egocentrism is not only common, but also robust and resilient."

"To overcome bias and negotiate effectively, you need a framework for thinking about, preparing for, and executing negotiations systematically and strategically."

(iii) Spread out the negotiation across *multiple sessions* to give yourself time to think in between.

- Use analogies to facilitate logical thinking. Review several negotiations simultaneously to identify similarities and differences, key learning principles and lessons.
- Adopt the “outsider lens” to detach yourself from the situation:
 - (i) Bring in an *outsider* during preparation, or assign someone to act as your devil’s advocate.
 - (ii) Assess the system as a *third party*, e.g. imagine you’re giving advice to a friend.
- Stop to consider how an offer compares with objective reference points, such as the status quo, your original target or BATNA.

 At the same time, you need to address others’ biases:

- Factor their biases into your plan/strategy.
- If you’re confident that your offer is better than what they can get elsewhere, then give them time to analyze and compare their options. You can also facilitate rational discussions by proposing a timeline to discuss specific issues or ask them to consider their relative priorities.
- Calibrate information, e.g. get opinions from several real-estate agents to ensure your agent’s list price isn’t biased.
- Use contingency contracts to cater to different viewpoints.



Using and Countering Strategies of Influence

 Use these strategies to influence others effectively:

- Leverage loss aversion by highlighting their potential losses, not their potential gains. For example, you can frame your proposal in terms of how much they’ll lose without your solution (not how much they’ll save/gain). Or, point out what’s missing from your rivals’ offer (instead of what your offer includes).

KEY QUOTES

“By giving up your ability to pursue what you want, you can ensure that you will do what you should.”

“Thinking about the decision biases of others allows you to calibrate, quantitatively and qualitatively, the information, data, and arguments that you hear from them.”

- Disaggregate their gains and aggregate their losses.
 - (i) We feel more satisfied with *many small wins* (instead of 1 big win). Make small concessions throughout the negotiation, share good news in small doses, and distribute your benefits/rewards in installments.
 - (ii) We feel less pain if we encounter 1 *big loss* (instead of many small ones). So, combine your demands, bad news or costs, and share them all at once.
- Use the Door-in-the-face (DITF) technique. Make an extreme request so they'll say "no", then quickly follow up with a moderate request. They're 3x more likely to say "yes" because the 2nd request seems like a concession, and appears more reasonable compared to the first.
- Use the Foot-in-the-door (FITD) technique. Start with a small request that they'll probably agree to, then wait a while before you make a bigger, related request. This plays on our desire to act consistently with past decisions and actions.
- People tend to say "yes" to requests with seemingly-legitimate justifications. You can increase the chances of an agreement just by adding the word "because".
- Something that's popular always seems more attractive. Use social proof by presenting a list of happy clients, high demand for a product, etc.
- Surveys sent with a \$1 note received a much higher response rate than those sent with a promised incentive of \$50. That's because people feel obliged to reciprocate when you give a unilateral concession. This works even for small/token concessions, e.g. meeting at their preferred time/place or buying coffee/snacks.
- Use reference points to make an offer/request look reasonable, e.g. a \$100 warranty looks small compared to a \$2,000 computer.

KEY QUOTES

"People seem to prefer finding money in installments but losing money in one lump sum."



Use these strategies to counter others' attempt to influence you:

- *Prepare in advance.* Know your interests, BATNA, ZOPA, etc. so you're less likely to accept an unfavorable offer.
- Use a scoring system to help you evaluate offers more objectively.
- Deliberately separate information from influence.
- *Rephrase their offer* in other terms, e.g. change a loss-frame to a gain-frame to see if it still sounds as attractive.
- *Appoint a devil's advocate.*
- Don't negotiate under time pressure.



Overcoming Blind Spots in Negotiation



Be mindful of these common blind spots in negotiations:

- Often, parties who're absent from the negotiation table (e.g. regulators or rivals) can affect the outcome.
- Your counterpart may be using different decision rules that you're unaware of.
- There may be information asymmetries that put the less-informed party at a disadvantage. For example, you may think you got a great deal for a used car because you're unaware of its major problems.
- Don't focus so much on your proposal that you overlook your competitors' strengths, nor focus narrowly on the immediate outcomes to neglect the big picture and longer-term implications.



Expand your focus/awareness to consider all factors in play. Learn from past negotiations, and get a team to help you with research/preparation for important negotiations.



Addressing Lies/Deception and Ethical Dilemmas



It's possible to be ethical without being taken advantage of.

KEY QUOTES

"For most negotiators, the decision rules of other parties lie outside the bounds of awareness."

"The best defense against lies and deception is to eliminate your counterpart's temptation to lie."

Most people admit to lying at some point in negotiations. People are less likely to lie if they don't feel the need to, or if they believe they can't get away with it. To minimize lies and deception:

- Use defensive strategies to discourage deception:
 - (i) Look prepared and show that you're able to obtain information to verify their data/claims.
 - (ii) Ask questions that're less direct or threatening so they won't feel the need to lie.
 - (iii) Build trust. Demonstrate openness and honesty, volunteer information and don't lie.
- Improve your ability to detect lies:
 - (i) Reduce information asymmetry with multiple sources of info.
 - (ii) Set a trap: ask a question (for which you already know the answer and they have reasons to lie) to see how they respond.
 - (iii) Ask more questions so it's hard for them to lie consistently.
 - (iv) Watch out for evasive responses.
 - (v) Use contingency contracts to protect yourself for contentious issues.
- Remove your own need/desire to lie:
 - (i) Consider the cost of your reputation and relationship.
 - (ii) Prepare for tough questions so you won't be caught offguard. Refuse to answer sensitive questions, or offer to answer a different question, e.g. "I can't share our cost figures, but I can explain our production process and pricing model to assure you that you're getting value for money."
 - (iii) Remove the constraints or incentives that tempt you to lie, e.g. don't respond under time pressure.

KEY QUOTES

"Someone must take the first step, and it may as well be the one who is aspiring to become a negotiation genius."

"Information asymmetry makes you vulnerable to deception."

"Most people do not like to lie, but they are usually very comfortable with you being deceived."

"Lies are not only potentially unethical; they are also, very often, poor strategy."



If you catch the other party lying:

- Don't call them a liar. Explain that you feel misled, and give them a chance to clarify.
- You can subtly warn them that their data seems "outdated" and your sources indicate a different number. Or, directly confront them by stating your disappointment with the misinformation.
- Decide if you wish to continue negotiating or walk away.



Most of us unknowingly make incorrect or self-serving statements. Be mindful of the situations where *anyone*—yourself included—may behave unethically.

- Conflicts of interest are common in negotiation. For example, a deal that maximizes a real-estate agent's earnings may not be one that serves the client's best interest. Always verify the info/advice or ask them to justify the recommendations.
- We may be unconsciously influenced by implicit assumptions and stereotypes. For example, we may assume that people of a certain race, gender, industry or negotiating style will think/act in a certain way, so we respond in a biased way.
- A deal can create value for both parties at the expense of third parties absent from the negotiating table, e.g. 2 companies agreeing to increase prices and pass the costs to consumers.
- We tend to overclaim credit or our "fair" share of rewards, without stopping to consider others' contribution.



Negotiating From a Position of Weakness



At some point, you'll have to negotiate with few/no good alternatives. When negotiating from a position of weakness:

- Don't reveal that your BATNA is weak. Instead, play up their weakness and your own unique traits. In the earlier example, Roosevelt's campaign manager was in a weak position since the photos were already printed. However,

KEY QUOTES

"It is often tempting—but not always judicious—to retaliate quickly when you feel you have been deceived."

"The one who fares better is the one who makes the other side's weakness more salient throughout the negotiation."

he focused on the photographer's weak BATNA (i.e. he'd lose a one-in-a-lifetime opportunity without a deal).

- Give multiple proposals to explore other variables that may be of value/interest to your counterpart. If you have other deals where you're in a stronger position, you can also negotiate across your whole portfolio.
- Use the time between deals to nurture the relationship and understand the client's needs/interests. Bypass the agents by sending a copy of the proposal to the client, or propose a PSS to add more value after you're selected.
- If your position is truly weak, it may be better to relinquish your power and ask for their help instead.



If all else fails and you're being bullied by the other party, try disrupting the power balance:

- Build coalitions with other weak parties to increase your strength.
- Point out that if they push too hard, they could destroy you and lose a value-creating partner.
- Attack their source of power. Before confronting a powerful salesperson who holds 70% of your accounts, weaken his position by building relationships with those clients and locking them into long-term contracts.



When Negotiations Turn Ugly



Negotiations can break down due to 5 problems:

- Irrationality: Don't assume that the other party is being unreasonable. Try to uncover the hidden causes behind their behavior, e.g. they may be misinformed or have other hidden constraints/interests.
- If distrust is an obstacle, diagnose the problem first (e.g. whether they distrust your character or competence, and why). Then, identify ways to rebuild trust.
- When the other party is angry:

KEY QUOTES

"If you can't outmuscle the other side in a negotiation, you may want to stop flexing your muscles and, instead, simply ask them to help you."

"If you create value for others, you gain at least some power to claim value for yourself."

"In most cases, behavior that appears to be irrational has a rational—albeit hidden—cause."

KEY QUOTES

"If you can sidestep the attack, you will avoid the hit, retain your balance, and remain in control of the situation."

"Unless the other side is able to save face...they may be very reluctant to change their perspective or their behavior."

(i) Acknowledge their anger and seek to *understand why*, e.g. "You seem to be angry. Can you share what's on your mind?"

(ii) *Sidestep the attack* and stay calm. Consider how you'd feel if you were in their shoes.

(iii) Refocus on their *real interests*. Ask: "What would you like to see happen?" or "What could help us to move forward?"

- When the other side resorts to threats and ultimatums:

(i) Ignore the threat by shifting to another topic;

(ii) Pre-empt additional threats by voicing their concerns and your willingness to help them resolve it.

(iii) Politely point out if their threat isn't credible or viable.

- Help them to back down without losing face. For example, if they clearly need to reduce the price further after issuing an ultimatum, you can say something like, "I realize you're doing us a favor by reducing the price beyond what's normally permissible. I really appreciate that."

 You shouldn't negotiate at all when:

- The costs of negotiation (including the value of your time, or the harm to a relationship) exceed the potential gains;

- Everyone knows that your BATNA sucks;

- Negotiation is inappropriate for the culture or context (e.g. negotiating a pay raise in the midst of a crisis); or

- There's no ZOPA, i.e. your BATNA exceeds their best possible offer.



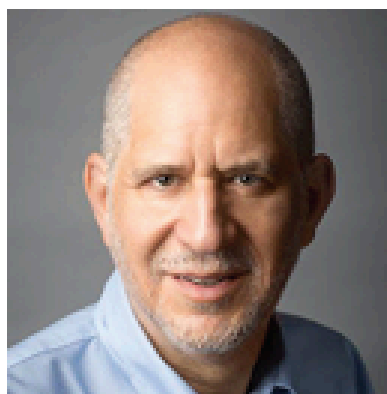
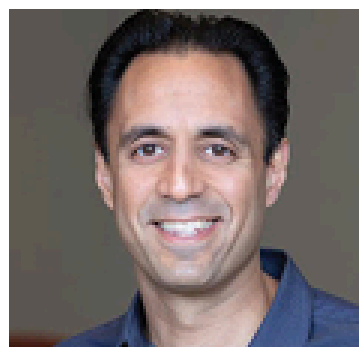
Other Details in the Book to Look Out for

This book provides the negotiation strategies and tools that can be applied to virtually any scenario. However, becoming a

negotiation genius takes time and continuous practice. The key is to keep taking small steps and making incremental improvements. Besides the insights in this summary, the book includes various case-studies and examples to help you understand how the principles and techniques can be applied in real-life. For more details, please visit <http://www.negotiationgenius.com/>.

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KEY QUOTES